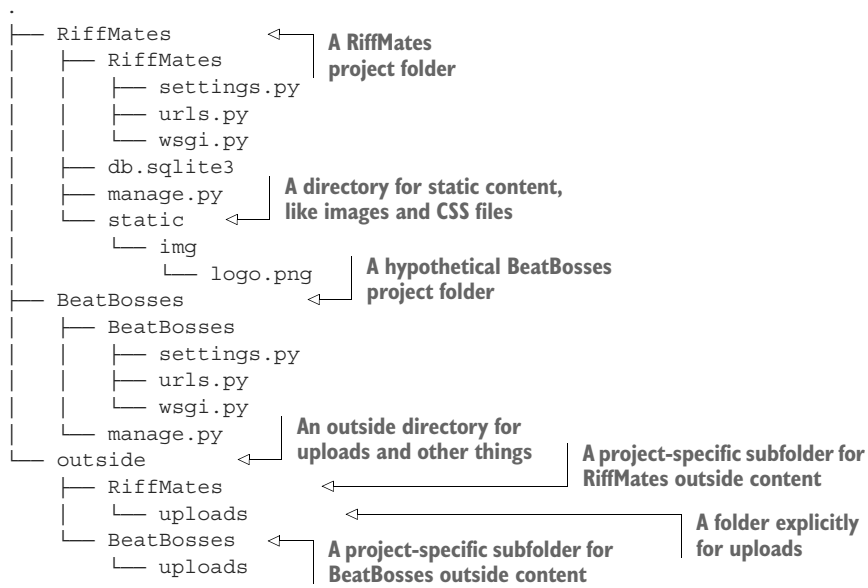
This outside directory can be used for other things as well, so I typically create an *uploads* directory inside the project folder. Here is a sample file tree for the RiffMates project, its associated outside folder, and a hypothetical second project called *BeatBosses*:



This file structure might be overkill for simpler projects, but I'm a fan of consistency and stick with the structure all the time. This means I don't have to think about it; I know exactly where everything is from project to project. Go ahead and create the necessary directories on your system.

Once you've got the directories in place, it is time to tell Django where they are. There are two configuration items you'll need: `MEDIA_URL` and `MEDIA_ROOT`. The first defines the base URL used to serve uploaded files—by convention, this is /media/. The second is the base file path of those files on your server. Add the following to your RiffMates/RiffMates/settings.py file:

```
# RiffMates/RiffMates/settings.py
...
MEDIA_ROOT = BASE_DIR.parent / 'outside/RiffMates/uploads'
MEDIA_URL = '/media/'
```

BASE_DIR.parent is the parent of the project directory. Everything after the / is the folder for RiffMates uploads.

The base URL for serving uploads

The Django development server does not serve these files by default, but you can add the capability. In the previous section, you learned about static files and how the development server can serve them. Under the covers, the dev server does this using the `static()` function. Yep, for those keeping track, that's a third thing with the same name. The function takes two arguments: the base URL to serve from and the location